Quarterly Examination(2023-24)
Class IX
English Language and Literature

Time: 2 Hrs. **M.M: 50**

Section A: Reading (10 Marks)

I. Read the following passage carefully: (5)

1. Around 194 millions birds and 29 million mammals are thought to be killed each year on European roads, according to a new study that has ranked the most vulnerable species. The research has found that the species killed most often were not necessarily the endangered species. This means action to preserve wildlife when new roads are built risks being targeted at the wrong species based on current methods. Road densities in Europe are among the world's highest, with 50% of the continent within 1.5 km of a paved road or railway. Roads are therefore a significant threat to wildlife, and evidence shows deaths on them could even cause some species to disappear completely.

2. Despite this, the long-term protection of species is not currently considered when assessing the impact of new roads on wildlife, meaning we risk giving support to only the endangered species, doing nothing to help those most at risk. A better understanding of which species are most vulnerable to roads is therefore important if we are to take a more effective action of protection.

3. A research team based in Lisbon calculated road-kill rates for 423 bird species and 212 mammal species. They found that small animals with high population densities and which mature at an early age were most likely to be killed on roads. Nocturnal mammals and birds with a diet of plants and seeds were also shown to have higher death rates.

4. The study also used the road-kill surveys to rank the birds and mammal species whose long-term survival was most threatened by road-kill. The hazel grouse and ground squirrel were found to be most at risk of local extinction. Both are common in Europe but are classified as species of Least Concern Red list of Threatened Species.

5. The most vulnerable animals classified as threatened by IUCN were the red-knobbed coot, Balkan mole and Podolian mole. The study revealed that road-kill hotspots were not the areas with the highest population of endangered species. For example, house sparrows had a high road-kill rate (2.7 per km/year) but were ranked 420th of 423 bird species for vulnerability. Conversely, the hazel grouse had a low predicted road kill-rate (0.2 per km/yr) but was most vulnerable of all birds studied.

On the basis of your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below:

(1) Hazel grouse and ground squirrel are classified as species of least concern. The statement is:

(a) a logical conclusion (b) a piece of good news (c) ironical (d) a pleasant surprise

(2) The title of the study should be:

(a) A Birds and Mammals surveys (b) Road-kills (c) Road density in Europe

(d) Need for conservation

(3) Replace the given phrase with a word from the passage that means the same thing: (para 5)

'On the other hand, it did not rain here all week.'

(4) Infer one reason for the following statement:

"They found that small animals… were most likely to be killed on roads."

(5) What do you think is the purpose of the study?

II. Read the passage carefully: (5)

1. In most societies that have any glimmering of civilization, a person accused of wrong doing is given at least a nominal chance of proving his innocence. The Romans had a highly sophisticated/comprehensive system of courts and the members of their legal profession were well educated but the Saxons who followed them to rule Britain used rougher methods.

2. From about the sixth century A.D. to the eleventh the majority of the trials were in the form of cruel physical torture carrying a piece of red hot iron, stepping barefoot and blindfold across a floor covered with red hot coals or sometimes by a gentler method of oathswearing.

3. The accused was ordered to bring to the Saxon authorities, a police officer or a priest could be persuaded to swear on oath or still a number of persons who would say that the accused was of good character and thus innocent. The number of persons who swore depended on the crime. A noble/a landlord or a priest counted for up to half a dozen ordinary peasants. As almost everyone lived in small villages, where almost everyone knew everyone else, and very few would risk telling a lie on oath (the people were mostly religious), the truth was generally told. If the accused could not produce enough oath helpers, he was found guilty and punished.

4. In the eleventh century, the Normans introduced trial by battle in certain cases. The accused and the accuser fought with special weapons until one was dead or surrendered. It was believed that God would know the guilty and give the innocent the power to win. The whole idea became ridiculous when both the parties were allowed to hire champions who would fight on their behalf. It seemed likely whoever could pay more for a stronger professional fighter stood a good chance of winning and judged innocent. This may sound unfair to us but there is a parallel with a wealthy person today who can hire a costly and brilliant barrister to defend him.

5. In the early middle ages when England was a land of small villages remote from each other, crime tended to be basic and direct : beating up, theft, sex and murder being the main offences. But as towns and commerce grew, the possibilities for cheating and fraud soared. The whole organisation of society became more complex and opened the door to a world of more sophisticated wickedness. With no regular police force, spies and informers were offered rewards when they brought in criminals.

On the basis of your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below:

(1) Fill in the blank using an appropriate sentence/ phrase from the passage: (para 5)

Opinion: As towns and commerce grew, the possibilities for cheating and fraud soared

Reason: ……

(2) Complete the analogy using a word from the passage.

Priest: Layman : : Amateur: .....

(3) Study the following statements:

(i) In a trial by battle, money played a main role.

(ii) God helped the innocent win the battle.

Options:

(a) (i) is right and (ii) is wrong.

(b) (ii) is right and (i) is wrong.

(c) Both (i) and (ii) are right and (i) is the conclusion.

(d) Both (i) and (ii) are right and (i) is not the conclusion.

(4.) 'There is not much difference between the Norman and modern system of justice.' Justify.

(5.) 'any glimmering of civilization'

'Glimmering' in the above expression has been used as a metaphor. Glimmering stands for:

(a) a slight suggestion

(b) a great hope

(c) some fear

(d) a little confidence

Section B: Writing and Grammar (10 Marks)

II. You are a member of the Eco Club of your school. Last month your school celebrated anti-pollution week. Various activities were conducted to create awareness among the students. Write a diary entry in about 100-120 words expressing what you learnt through these activities.

(4)

OR

Write a short story in about 100-120 words that begin with the following line:

"When the rain finally stopped after four days, we came out of our houses to continue with our normal routines but ……."

III. Choose the correct option to fill in the blanks: (4x1/2=2)

1. We ……. (go) to Mumbai by Shatabdi Express last month.

   (i) went (ii) gone (iii) had gone (iv) were going

2. Sri Shakti Express train ……. (be) a fully air-conditioned train.

   (i) is (ii) has (iii) are (iv) were

3. This Home Stay…… (provide) food, cold drinks, water and the blankets at night.

   (i) provided (ii) has provided (iii) will provide (iv) provides

4. The journey to Spiti Valley…… (be) cool. It imparted solace to the soul and mind.

   (i) is (ii) was (iii) has been (iv) were

IV. The following passage has not been edited. There is an error in each line.

Write the error and its correction as shown: (2x1=2)

		Incorrect	**Correct**
Disasters often come suddenly with warning	e.g.	…with	……without…
and causes great suffering to those	(a)	……	……
who are left alive.			
Because the victims of the same require immediate help.	(b)	……..	…….

V. Fill in the blanks with correct form verb that agrees with the subject: (4x1/2=2)

1. A pair of branded shoes …… (is/are) quite expensive these days.
2. Rajesh as well as his friends ……(was/were) missing.
3. The cartel of oil supplying countries ……. (has/have) submitted the report.
4. I've been there many a …… . (time/times)

Section C: Textbooks (30 Marks)

VII. Reference to the context:

1. **Read the following extract carefully and choose the correct option: (3x1=3)**

Unfortunately I could not accompany Grandfather on that trip, but he told me about it afterwards. A big black canvas kit-bag was provided for Toto. This, with some straw at the bottom, became his new abode. When the bag was closed, there was no escape. Toto could not get his hands through the opening, and the canvas was too strong for him to bite his way through. His efforts to get out only had the effect of making the bag roll about on the floor or occasionally jump into the air – an exhibition that attracted a curious crowd of onlookers on the Dehra Dun railway platform. Toto remained in the bag as far as Saharanpur, but while grandfather was producing his ticket at the railway turnstile, Toto suddenly poked his head out of the bag and gave the ticket-collector a wide grin.

(i) Why was some straw put at the bottom of the bag?

(a) For Toto's eating (b) For Toto's warming up

(c) For Toto's sound sleep (d) To make the bag comfortable for Toto

(ii) Why do you think Toto was taken to Saharanpur?

(a) For the treatment of his illness (b) Toto was disturbing the other pets at home

(c) Grandfather loved Toto a lot (d) All of these

(iii) Based on the extract, which of the following statements is NOT TRUE?

1. Toto was taken in the canvas kit-bag so that he could not escape.
2. Toto was a well- behaved pet animal.
3. Toto's poking out his head resulted in the grandfather's loss of some money.
4. The narrator felt happy not to accompany his grandfather
5. Toto's rolling about on the floor draw the attention of onlookers.

(a) Option 1 and 4 (b) Option 3 and 5

(c) Option 2 and 5 (d) Option 2 and 4

2. Read the stanza given below and choose the correct option: (3x1=3)

You're very clever at poking fun at weaklings.

Frail crumbling houses, crumbling doors, crumbling rafters,

crumbling wood, crumbling bodies, crumbling lives,

crumbling hearts –

the wind god winnows and crushed them all.

(i) How do weaklings suffer at the hands of the wind?

(a) It shakes them up (b) It beats them up

(c) It pokes fun at them (d) It makes them to what it wants

(ii) What does the wind do to all the crumbling things it comes across?

(a) It laughs at them (b) It heals them

(c) It blows gently over them (d) It crushes them

(iii) Which poetic device has been used in the first line of the given stanza?

(a) Alliteration (b) Metaphor

(c) Simile (d) Personification

VIII. Answer in about 40-50 words: (4x3=12)

1. Give an account of Bismillah Khan's memorable performances abroad?
2. What is the significance of 'bent in the undergrowth?' Discuss.
3. The child's parents would have refused to buy him a garland. Why?
4. How did Toto behave when he was put in the closet?

IX. Answer any <u>one</u> in about 100-120 words: (6)

1. In the text 'The Fun They Had' the author warns against the dangers of computerized schooling which deprives children of the benefits of the personal interactions between

students and teachers, which can help them develop social skills.Discuss.

2. The poet in the poem 'Wind' is a great humanist whose heart is filled with compassion for mankind. Elucidate.

X. Answer any <u>one</u> in about 100-120 words: (6)

1. In his short story about a child, Mulk Raj Anand portrays a child's aspiration, demands and realization. He was attracted by many things around him but finally longed for his parents. What made him do so? Explain.

2. 'The monkey and the donkey never became friends.' Was there anything missing in their relationship. Discuss with reference to the text. .

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